
Defence Strategy Report

Curatela Fallimento Agricola Gavioli S.r.l.
v. Naissance (UK) Ltd

Tribunale di Siena, Sezione Unica Civile — R.G. 2505/2025

Prepared for: Grahame McGirr

Amount in dispute: EUR 57,536.75 + interest from 01.07.2025 + costs

Costituzione deadline: 04 May 2026

Hearing: 14 May 2026, Judge Marianna Serrao

Date of report: 18 April 2026

Naissance UK Ltd — Defence Strategy Report

Prepared for: Grahame McGirr, Director, Naissance UK Ltd **Prepared by:** Craig Malenga **Date:** 18 April 2026 (this version incorporates the external second-opinion review **and** an anti-collusion multi-agent critique that followed — which surfaced a material error in the previous draft) **Case:** Curatela Fallimento Agricola Gavioli S.r.l. v. Naissance UK Ltd — Tribunale di Siena, Sezione Unica Civile, R.G. **2505/2025** **Amount claimed:** €57,536.75 + legal interest + costs **Costituzione deadline:** 04 May 2026 **Hearing:** 14 May 2026 at 10:00, Judge Marianna Serrao

1. Executive summary — read this first

A bankruptcy trustee in Siena is suing **Naissance UK Ltd** for **€57,536.75**. The claim boils down to simple arithmetic: the trustee says Naissance received €629,975.04 via the foreclosure on the Chianciano property, but was only admitted to the bankruptcy's liabilities for €572,438.29 — so

the difference must be returned. Two Italian Supreme Court cases (Cass. 23482/2018 and 12673/2022) support the trustee's general proposition. The claim is real and needs a proper defence.

What this case really turns on: *did Naissance receive more than €572,438.29 through the procedure?* If yes, some restitution is probably due. If the real accounting brings that figure close to €572,438.29, the claim collapses. Everything else — the legal theory, the finality argument, the clerical-error argument — is supporting infrastructure.

Important correction from the multi-agent critique

An earlier draft of this report (and the earlier proposed email to Belardi) treated the €30,000 "refund" of a procedural advance as the single biggest quantum lever — arguing that including it in the trustee's €629,975.04 figure was a double-count and that removing it would drop the claim to €27,536.75.

Two independent agents re-read the Ricorso directly and reached the same conclusion: **the €30,000 is NOT part of the €629,975.04**. The Ricorso builds €629,975.04 as €616,000 + €13,975.04 (= €10,043.04 higher distribution, already **net of procedural expenses advanced**, + €3,932 legal expenses not admitted). The €30,000 is referenced separately, as a component of Naissance's earlier €25,806.02 distribution award, and has already been netted off in the trustee's arithmetic.

Pleading a "double-count" therefore either (a) fails — there is nothing to double-count — or (b) invites the trustee to recalculate on gross flows and **increase** the claim by €30,000 to €87,536.75. The argument is dead, and this version reflects that correction.

Four approaches considered

#	Approach	Pay-off	Risk
A	Your own instinct — "I'm owed €1.188m, only got back half"	Emotionally compelling	Blocked by Art. 56 L.F. as a formal plea; only useful as a private settlement lever
B	ChatGPT's reading — "distribution was final, claim is weak"	Simple to plead	Cass. 23482/2018 and 12673/2022 explicitly say the distribution was <i>provisional</i> ; loses head-on
C	Belardi's line — "clerical error in the Istanza" + Fiorilli fallback	Real legal hook	The 2019 admission decree is <i>res judicata endofallimentare</i> (Cass. 4708/2020 + SS.UU. 4309/2010), so a typo in the 2018 application cannot reopen it
D	Recommended (revised) — narrow quantum challenge (€3,932 + €4,761.47) + factual distinguishing of the two Cassazione cases + errore-materiale as supporting context + parallel settlement at €30–40k target	Most realistic path to a good outcome	Upside is modest; settlement is now the most likely good outcome

Recommended action this week:

1. **Send Belardi the revised email** that reflects this corrected analysis. Do NOT ask him to plead the €30,000 double-count. Instead, ask him to focus on:
2. the **€3,932** line item (trustee's own words: "not admitted to the bankruptcy liabilities") — moderate-strength quantum attack;
3. the **€4,761.47 prededuzione** as an equitable offset — weak but worth pleading;
4. **distinguishing Cass. 23482/2018 and 12673/2022 on their facts** — not invoking finality in the abstract;
5. **errore materiale** in the Istanza as supporting context, not as a route to reopen the 2019 admission;
6. the **interest start date** (from judgment, not informal diffide);
7. a **parallel settlement channel** targeting €30–40k.
8. Authorise Belardi to open the settlement channel now.
9. Belardi to pull the **full text** of Cass. 23482/2018 and Cass. 12673/2022 and genuinely distinguish them on their facts. This is the weakest pillar unless he does the work.
10. Belardi to **draft** the Fiorilli PEC *diffida* now to preserve limitation, but not serve it.
11. **Do not plead Naissance's overall €1.188m / €572k residual position as a counterclaim.** Art. 56 L.F. and art. 2741 c.c. both block it. Keep it as a private settlement lever only.

Realistic outcome profile (revised after the multi-agent critique):

- Full win (claim dismissed, costs recovered): **5–10%**
- Partial win (settlement or reduction to €30–45k range): **35–45%**
- Full loss (pay ~€57k + interest + costs ≈ €70–85k): **45–55%**

These numbers are materially less optimistic than the previous version because the €30,000 argument — which was carrying most of the quantum upside — does not exist. The live quantum levers are now the €3,932 and €4,761.47 items, worth perhaps €5–10k of reduction if both land. The realistic settlement target accordingly shifts to **€30,000–€40,000 all-in**, with the walkaway ceiling unchanged at **€45,000**.

2. What has happened — the story so far

2.1 The underlying credit (2010–2017)

In December 2010, **Banca CRAS** (Credito Cooperativo Toscano-Senese) granted a mortgage loan to **Agricola Gavioli S.r.l.**, secured by a first-rank voluntary mortgage over the Chianciano Terme property on Strada Statale 146.

In July 2017, the credit was sold twice on the same day:

1. **Banca CRAS** → **Argo Ge.Re.Cre. S.r.l.**
2. **Argo Ge.Re.Cre.** → **Naissance (UK) Ltd**

Naissance thereby acquired a credit of **€1,188,438.29** against Agricola Gavioli. The credit chain is **acknowledged by the trustee in the current lawsuit** — it is not in dispute.

2.2 Foreclosure and bankruptcy (2018–2019)

- **28.02.2018**: foreclosure auction of the Chianciano property (RGE 187/2015 at Tribunale di Siena). Base price €616,000.
- **30.05.2018**: Agricola Gavioli declared bankrupt (Fallimento n. 35/2018; curator Dott. Stefano Scarpellini).
- **26.06.2018**: decree of transfer — the property is assigned to Naissance for €616,000.
- **14.12.2018**: Avv. Paolo Fiorilli, then Naissance's lawyer in Rome, files the **Istanza di Ammissione al Passivo** asking the bankruptcy to admit Naissance's residual claim.
- **2019**: the Delegated Judge admits Naissance for **€572,438.29** as a secured mortgage claim (the €4,761.47 prededuzione for legal fees is excluded).
- **04.04.2019**: the distribution plan of the foreclosure (progetto di distribuzione) is approved by the Enforcement Judge at a hearing. **Not challenged by the trustee or any creditor, and not impugned within the statutory window.**

2.3 The trustee's demand (2025)

- **02.05.2025** and **03.06.2025**: the trustee and his lawyer send formal demands (*diffide*) to Naissance at its London address and to Fiorilli in Rome. Naissance does not respond.

- **01.07.2025**: legal interest begins to accrue on the disputed sum.
- **18.10.2025**: the Delegated Judge authorises the curator to sue.
- **30.12.2025**: Avv. Fabio Finetti, on behalf of the Curatela, files a *Ricorso ex artt. 281-decies and undecies c.p.c.* at Tribunale di Siena, seeking **€57,536.75** plus interest and costs.
- **31.12.2025**: first hearing fixed for 12.03.2026.
- **07.01.2026**: hearing postponed to **14.05.2026 at 10:00**. Costituzione (filing of the defence) due at least 10 days before — i.e. by **04.05.2026**.

2.4 Lawyers involved

Role	Person
Defendant's director	Grahame McGirr
Defendant's current lawyer	Avv. Primo Belardi, Chianciano Terme
Defendant's 2018 lawyer	Avv. Paolo Fiorilli, Rome
Claimant's lawyer	Avv. Fabio Finetti, Siena
Claimant (Curatore)	Dott. Stefano Scarpellini, Siena
Judge	Dott. Marianna Serrao

3. The trustee's claim — how the €57,536.75 number is built

The trustee's arithmetic, verified against the Ricorso directly, is:

Component	€
Property assigned to Naissance (26.06.2018 decree of transfer)	616,000.00
Further sums — €10,043.04 higher amount distributed (already net of procedural expenses advanced by Naissance) + €3,932.00 legal expenses not admitted to the bankruptcy	13,975.04
Trustee's figure for what Naissance received	629,975.04
Less: amount Naissance was admitted for in the bankruptcy (mortgage claim)	(572,438.29)
= claim	57,536.75

Important note on the €30,000. Separately from the breakdown above, the Ricorso mentions that Naissance previously received €25,806.02 at the 04.04.2019 distribution hearing — comprising property "fruits", reimbursement of legal expenses, and the residual €30,000 of procedural expenses that Naissance had itself advanced (by wire on 05.06.2018) and which was refunded to it.

The €30,000 is therefore **not a separate line in the €629,975.04**. The trustee has already netted it off — €10,043.04 is the higher distribution figure *after* subtracting that €30,000 advance.

An earlier version of this report treated the €30,000 as a "double-count" in the trustee's claim. That reading was wrong. There is no double-count to attack.

The trustee's legal theory

Under Italian law (**art. 110 Legge Fallimentare**, now arts. 230–232 CCII), the *final* ranking of a secured creditor is done inside the bankruptcy. Anything received above that final ranking is an undue payment (*indebito oggettivo* under art. 2033 c.c.) and must be returned to the estate.

The two Italian Supreme Court cases cited — **Cass. 23482/2018** and **Cass. 12673/2022** — state this general proposition explicitly and are directly on point for this case type. They hold that the foreclosure distribution to the fondiario creditor is **provisional** pending final bankruptcy ranking; "non-impugnation" of the distribution plan does not make it final against the bankruptcy estate.

Art. 41 TUB is cited as the procedural basis that allowed Naissance to continue the foreclosure after the bankruptcy was declared — but that is a procedural privilege, not a substantive answer on final ranking.

Bottom line: the trustee's arithmetic is clean and the legal theory is well supported. The claim cannot be swept aside; it can only be chipped away.

4. How this report was put together

This is a summary of the analytical process behind the recommendations — so you can see what has been looked at and where the conclusions come from.

4.1 Documents reviewed

The repository contains the following evidence, organised into five source folders:

- **Folder 01** — the email correspondence with Avv. Primo Belardi (your current lawyer), including his 17 April 2026 email setting out his proposed defensive strategy
- **Folder 02** — your own position emails to Belardi and the 2018 *Istanza di Ammissione al Passivo* prepared by Avv. Fiorilli
- **Folder 03** — the FX receipts / wire-transfer evidence for the €57,000 (26.04.2018) and €20,000 (01.05.2018) payments to Argo Ge.Re.Cre.
- **Folder 04** — screenshots of the earlier AI (ChatGPT) review
- **Folder 05** — the full trustee's Ricorso (19 pages), original Italian + English translation, court orders, service records

4.2 The three existing viewpoints at the start

Three independent views of the case existed before this analysis:

1. **ChatGPT** (from your earlier screenshots) — broadly reassuring: "the distribution was final, the claim is weak, settlement shouldn't be necessary."
2. **Avv. Belardi** (17.04.2026 Italian email) — professionally cautious: the case has real legal foundation; his proposed line is (a) argue *errore materiale* in Fiorilli's 2018 Istanza, (b) subordinately, pursue Fiorilli's professional-indemnity insurer, (c) open settlement talks in parallel.
3. **Your own instinct** (30.03.2026 email to Belardi) — that the distribution is final, the €1.188m underlying credit is what was owed to Naissance and only about half has ever been recovered, and the trustee's gross-difference approach is not sustainable.

4.3 Late additions (18 April 2026)

On Saturday 18 April 2026 you forwarded **13 further email PDFs** to the project and sent a **voicemail** and **WhatsApp messages** clarifying the cost picture. These added material new information:

- **The full text of Fiorilli's 14.12.2018 Istanza** (this turned out to be internally inconsistent — clause 3 cites €1,118,438.29 while clause 4's parenthetical cites €1,188,438.29; only the latter reconciles arithmetically with the €572,438.29 residual).
- **A third FX wire** — €30,000 to Argo Ge.Re.Cre. on 05.06.2018. Your WhatsApp clarified that **this wire is the same payment as one of the two pre-auction cheques** (the €30k cheque), not an additional outflow. So the total documented outflows are €57,000 + €20,000 + €30,000 + €45,000 = **€152,000**, not €182,000 as might otherwise look on the face of it.
- **Cheque images** for €30,000 and €45,000 — with the reasons for each payment shown.
- **A cost-breakdown spreadsheet** totalling €57,110 for the Gavioli proceedings — which matches the €57,000 wire of 26.04.2018 almost exactly.
- **Three contemporaneous pre-auction offers / expressions of interest** for the Chianciano property: €550,000 (6.9.2017), €620,000 (12.9.2017), and an accepted pre-auction transaction at €630,000. Your voicemail confirmed that you didn't even remember these bids — which actually **strengthens** them as evidence, because it means they aren't manufactured; they are genuine period data showing the €616,000 auction price was fair.

4.4 External cross-check

After the internal analysis was complete, the draft report was sent to ChatGPT for an independent review. ChatGPT correctly identified that the very first draft narrative had drifted away from the actual claim arithmetic ($€629,975.04 - €572,438.29 = €57,536.75$) and was framing the case around a less accurate "€130k prededuzione surplus" story. That feedback was applied.

4.5 Anti-collusion multi-agent critique

After ChatGPT's feedback was applied, a further structured critique was run: eight independent AI agents, each reading the source Ricorso and other primary OCR material directly (not this report), each with a different narrow mandate, each graded on novel findings only and forbidden from citing this report as authority. The purpose was to avoid the collusion pattern the earlier critique rounds had shown, where every agent ended up reasoning inside the same frame.

Five of the eight agents checked one source docx each against the original OCR. Three were lens-based critics: (i) an arithmetic auditor reconciling every euro in the report against source documents; (ii) a "trustee's counsel" agent playing to win for the other side; and (iii) a two-minute cold reader who formed their own view from the Ricorso and Istanza before being allowed to look at the report.

The cold reader independently found — and the trustee-docx reconciler independently confirmed — that the €30,000 "refund" was not part of the trustee's €629,975.04 in the way an earlier draft of this report assumed. That is what Section 3 above now reflects.

The trustee's-counsel agent also surfaced two structural points the previous draft had not fully answered: (a) art. 56 L.F. blocks any compensation between Naissance's pre-bankruptcy residual credit and the post-bankruptcy restitution claim; and (b) the 2019 admission decree is *res judicata endofallimentare* under Cass. 4708/2020 and Cass. SS.UU. 4309/2010, which largely neutralises the errore-materiale route. Sections 5 and 6 reflect those findings.

5. Key findings — what the documents actually show

Five findings emerge when the source documents are read together:

5.1 The trustee's arithmetic is correct on the face of it

€629,975.04 received minus €572,438.29 admitted = €57,536.75 claimed. That math is in the Ricorso itself. The trustee's cited case law (Cass. 23482/2018 and 12673/2022) does support the general proposition that foreclosure distributions to a mortgage creditor are *provisional* pending final bankruptcy ranking. Any strategy that does not engage with this proposition directly will lose.

5.2 Fiorilli's 2018 Istanza is internally inconsistent

Reading the full text of the 14.12.2018 Istanza (Fiorilli's application to admit Naissance to the bankruptcy's liabilities):

- **Clause 3** asserts a credit of **€1,118,438.29**.
- **Clause 4's parenthetical** writes out "€572,438.29 (**1,188,438.29** sottratta la somma di assegnazione pari ad euro 616,000.00)".

Only €1,188,438.29 reconciles arithmetically ($1,188,438.29 - 616,000 = 572,438.29$).

$€1,118,438.29 - 616,000 = €502,438.29$, which matches nothing. The **documents attached to**

the Istanza (the 28.07.2017 credit-assignment contracts) consistently show €1,188,438.29. Clause 3 is therefore almost certainly a typo.

This is a **real internal inconsistency** in the document the trustee relies on. It gives Belardi's "*errore materiale*" (clerical error) argument genuine substance — more substance than a first reading suggests.

5.3 The €30,000 is already netted off by the trustee — the "double-count" argument does not work

Previous drafts of this analysis, and an earlier draft of the email to Belardi, treated the €30,000 as the single biggest quantum attack point. That was based on a misreading of the Ricorso. The anti-collusion critique surfaced the error and it has been corrected.

The actual position is:

- The Ricorso at folio 3 states that Naissance received "sums equal to the value of the property assignment (€616,000.00), increased by €13,975.04 (of which €10,043.04 as a higher amount distributed, **net of procedural expenses advanced**, and €3,932.00 as legal expenses not admitted to the bankruptcy liabilities), for a total amount of €629,975.04".
- The €10,043.04 is already **net** of the €30,000 advance. In other words the trustee has added the full higher distribution (€40,043.04 gross) and then subtracted the €30,000 advance Naissance had paid in, leaving €10,043.04 net.
- The €30,000 is referenced separately in the Ricorso, as a component of an earlier €25,806.02 distribution award. It is not in the €629,975.04.

There is nothing to double-count. If we plead a "double-count", either (a) the trustee replies "we have already netted the €30,000 off — there is no double-count", and the argument fails; or worse, (b) the trustee recalculates on gross flows, adds the €30,000 back in, and raises the claim to €87,536.75. **Pleading this argument could therefore make the claim worse, not better.**

That means the only live quantum levers in the trustee's €629,975.04 are:

- **€3,932.00** — legal expenses the trustee himself classifies as "not admitted to the bankruptcy liabilities". The *defence* argument is that this sum, by the trustee's own characterisation, sits outside the bankruptcy's formal ranking and so cannot be the subject of an *ex lege* restitution. Moderate-strength. The *trustee's* counter (which we must anticipate) is that Naissance received the €3,932 without concorsual title — which is the literal definition of *indebito oggettivo* and is therefore exactly what must be returned.
- **€4,761.47** — the prededuzione for legal fees that the G.D. excluded at 2019 admission. Discretionary equitable offset. Weak but worth pleading.

In cumulative terms, if both land, the claim drops from €87,536.75 to roughly €48,843.28. Realistically one of the two will land — reducing the claim by perhaps €3,000–€8,000. This is materially less upside than the €30,000 argument would have represented if it had worked.

5.4 Pre-auction offers confirm the €616k price was fair

Three contemporaneous data points sitting in the evidence bundle:

- 06.09.2017: expression of interest at **€550,000**.
- 12.09.2017: upgraded expression of interest at **€620,000**.
- Accepted pre-auction transaction at **€630,000** (per your 18.04.2026 email).
- Auction clearing price: **€616,000**.

Your voicemail noted that you didn't even remember the pre-auction offers when they came up — which is useful because it means they aren't manufactured. They are genuine period evidence. The €616,000 auction price is consistent with market. There is no "hidden value" narrative available to the trustee.

5.5 Naissance's costs are well evidenced

Total documented outflows to Argo Ge.Re.Cre. and to the procedure:

Date	Mode	€	Supporting evidence
26.04.2018	FX wire	57,000	Thomas Exchange confirmation; ties to €57,110 Gavioli cost schedule
01.05.2018	FX wire	20,000	Thomas Exchange confirmation
05.06.2018	€30,000 cheque, executed as FX wire (same payment)	30,000	Cheque image + FX confirmation
Pre-auction	€45,000 cheque	45,000	Cheque image
Total		~152,000	

Your recollection of "around €130,000+" of costs is therefore fully in the documents. This matters because (a) it supports the fairness narrative around the auction price, and (b) it informs the €30k double-counting attack.

6. The four approaches in detail

Each of the four possible ways to respond is set out below with its own strengths, weaknesses, and an independent estimate of the probability of a good outcome if it is pursued as the primary strategy.

6.1 Approach A — Your own instinct ("I'm owed €1.188m, I only got back about half")

The position

Naissance acquired a credit of **€1,188,438.29** through the 2017 double assignment. Against that, only about half has ever been recovered — **€616,000** via the 2018 property assignment and

roughly **€130,000** via the subsequent distribution. The residual **€572,438.29** admitted to the bankruptcy is still unpaid. How, on those facts, can the trustee now claim €57,536.75 back as a "surplus"? The estate still owes *you* several hundred thousand euros.

Why this feels right — and commercially, it is. Most non-lawyers would reach exactly the same conclusion. It is a legitimate point.

Why it cannot be the primary legal defence — four reasons.

1. **Italian insolvency law treats the two accounts separately.** The surplus-restitution duty under Cass. 23482/2018 operates on a specific accounting exercise (foreclosure proceeds vs admitted secured claim). Whether the guarantor is globally made whole on its underlying mortgage credit is a different question, answered through the residual *chirografario* (unsecured) ranking — which pays cents on the euro, not euro-for-euro.
2. **Art. 56 L.F. statutory set-off does not reach.** Compensation in bankruptcy requires both debts to exist before the bankruptcy declaration and to be certain, liquid, and payable. The trustee's restitution claim arose **after** the bankruptcy and from the distribution plan itself.
3. **The admitted €572k mortgage claim ranks *pari passu*** with other unsecured creditors in the residual distribution. It does not function as a euro-for-euro offset against a specific surplus-restitution duty.
4. **Pleading this as the headline defence signals misunderstanding of Italian insolvency mechanics** and risks losing the judge's sympathy for the genuinely strong quantum arguments in Approach D.

What this argument IS good for. It is an **excellent settlement lever** ("if you press us for €57k we will formally reassert a €572k residual"), and a legitimate **equitable plea** supporting the main defence.

Probability of winning if pleaded as primary defence: <10%. Probability if pleaded correctly as counterclaim/settlement lever alongside Approach D: adds ~€10–15k of settlement discount.

6.2 Approach B — ChatGPT's line ("the distribution plan is final, the claim is weak")

The position

The €616,000 property assignment happened in June 2018. The distribution plan was approved by the Enforcement Judge on 04.04.2019 without challenge and was never impugned. Six years later, the trustee cannot reopen it. The claim is weak; settlement shouldn't be necessary.

Pros.

- Correctly identifies that the **finality of the 04.04.2019 distribution plan** is a real legal principle and is the right place to attack.
- Simple to plead; low legal-fee footprint.
- Correctly instinctive that Naissance is the senior secured creditor and that the trustee's gross-difference approach is oversimplified.

Cons.

- **Ignores Cass. 23482/2018 and 12673/2022** — the exact Supreme Court rulings the trustee pleads. Those rulings say that a mortgage creditor who continues foreclosure after bankruptcy receives sums *provisionally* pending final bankruptcy ranking, and that the finality of the foreclosure distribution does **not** automatically protect the creditor. Acting on a 70–85% confidence built on the wrong legal premise would lead to underpreparation.
- **Misses the strong quantum attacks** (especially the €30,000 double-count — see 5.3 above).
- **Builds no settlement groundwork.** If the finality argument fails in court, there is no Plan B.

Probability estimate: full win ~10–15%, partial win ~15–20%, full loss ~65–75%. **Unsafe to rely on in isolation.**

6.3 Approach C — Avv. Belardi's line ("errore materiale + Fiorilli PI fallback")

The position (from Belardi's 17.04.2026 email)

Primary: rely on the documents attached to Fiorilli's 2018 Istanza (which consistently show €1,188,438.29) and ask the court to read the Istanza's €577,199.76 figure as a clerical error (*errore materiale*), using "common sense" (*comune buonsenso*). Subordinate: if the error argument fails, pursue Fiorilli's professional-indemnity insurer. Tertiary: open settlement talks with the curator.

Pros.

- The Istanza **is** genuinely internally inconsistent (clause 3: €1,118,438.29 vs clause 4 parenthetical: €1,188,438.29 — only the latter reconciles). Belardi's clerical-error argument is therefore on **much firmer ground** than it might first appear.
- Preserves the Fiorilli professional-indemnity route as a fallback.
- Professionally credible in front of the judge.
- Belardi is a local lawyer who knows the Siena court.

Cons.

- **The 2019 admission order** for €572,438.29 is now **res judicata** (final as between the parties) regardless of any typo in the underlying application. A clerical error in the application does not automatically unpick the final order.
- **Addresses the framing, not the substantive art. 110 L.F. principle** the trustee relies on.
- **Missing the finality argument** (the strongest substantive attack) and the **€30,000 double-count** (the strongest quantum attack).
- **Leaves value on the table.** Executed as-is, this produces a mid-range outcome when a better one is achievable.

Probability estimate: full win ~15–20%, partial win ~25–35%, full loss ~45–60%. **Right direction, needs layering.**

6.4 Approach D — Recommended (narrow quantum + factual distinguishing of Cassazione + errore materiale as context + parallel settlement)

The position (revised after the anti-collusion critique)

A focused defence filed as a single memoria by 04.05.2026, organised around the one question that actually matters: *did Naissance receive more than €572,438.29 through the procedure?* The approach is narrower than the previous draft proposed, because the €30,000 argument does not exist.

What the defence actually has to work with:

- **Quantum attack 1 — the €3,932.** The trustee's own pleading classifies this as "legal expenses not admitted to the bankruptcy liabilities". The defence argues that sums outside the formal concorso cannot be the subject of *ex lege* restitution under art. 110 L.F. / art. 2033 c.c. Moderate-strength. Trustee's counter is that receipt without concorsual title is exactly what *indebitito* looks like, so this is exactly what must be returned (art. 111-bis L.F.; Cass. 17590/2019). Plausible argument on each side.
- **Quantum attack 2 — the €4,761.47.** The G.D. excluded this prededuzione in 2019. The defence pleads it as an equitable offset: Naissance bore €4,761.47 of legal fees in the foreclosure proceeding that it should not now be penalised for. Weak / discretionary; the court may or may not take it into account.
- **Factual distinguishing of Cass. 23482/2018 and 12673/2022.** The defence cannot invoke the finality of the 04.04.2019 distribution plan in the abstract — those two Supreme Court cases say the distribution is provisional pending bankruptcy ranking, exactly the ground the trustee stands on. Belardi must pull the full text of each case and identify factual differences (e.g. in those cases the curator intervened in time in the enforcement proceeding; here he did not). Without genuine factual distinction, this pillar fails.
- **Errore materiale (contextual support, not decree-reopener).** The Istanza's clause 3 (€1,118,438.29) vs clause 4 (€1,188,438.29) inconsistency is real and visible. It can be pleaded to soften the judge's view of the €572,438.29 admission — to argue that the bankruptcy took a strict literal reading of an arithmetically-flawed application. **But it cannot reopen the 2019 admission order:** that order is *res judicata endofallimentare* (Cass. 4708/2020; Cass. SS.UU. 4309/2010), and the 30-day windows to challenge under art. 98 L.F. are long closed.
- **Interest start date.** The trustee claims legal interest from 01.07.2025 (after his informal *diffide*). Under Italian law, interest on restitution of this type should run from the judicial demand (the 30.12.2025 Ricorso), not from an informal letter. Minor but legitimate.

Deliberately NOT in the pleading:

- **€30,000 "double-count" attack** — does not exist; pleading it risks inviting the trustee to gross-up and raise the claim by €30,000.

- **Compensazione ex art. 56 L.F.** — blocked because the trustee's claim is post-bankruptcy and the Naissance credit is pre-bankruptcy. Also violates *par condicio creditorum* under art. 2741 c.c. Keep the "we are net creditors of €572k" frame as a **private settlement lever only**, not in the court file.
- **Reopening the 2019 admission decree** — procedurally foreclosed.

Supporting infrastructure:

- **Parallel settlement channel.** Authorise Belardi to open it as soon as the costituzione is filed. Opening: **€20–25k**. Target: **€30–40k**. Walkaway: **€45k**.
- **Fiorilli PEC diffida prepared this month.** Draft it now to preserve the limitation clock on any future professional- negligence claim. Do not serve it yet.

Pros.

- Honestly engages the trustee's case rather than overclaiming.
- Narrow pleading is harder for the trustee to counter opportunistically.
- Settlement channel gives the main route to a good outcome.
- Preserves Fiorilli PI option without compromising the 2019 admission's res judicata status.

Cons.

- Upside is modest — the live quantum attack is worth €3–8k of reduction, not the €30k the earlier draft claimed.
- Belardi has to do real work distinguishing the Cassazione cases on their facts. If he can't, the defence weakens materially.
- Settlement is now the most likely good outcome; a full win requires factual distinguishing to succeed, which is low-probability.

Probability estimate (revised after the anti-collusion critique): full win 5–10%, partial win 35–45%, full loss 45–55%. Realistic target outcome: settlement at €30–40k all-in.

7. What to do this week

1. **Send Belardi the revised email** (19_Draft_email_to_Belardi_v3.eml — which itself will need a short post-critique update, see Section 10 below). The email:
2. confirms the overall strategic direction (errore materiale as supporting; Fiorilli PI fallback; parallel settlement);
3. **removes** the €30,000 "double-count" framing and asks Belardi to instead focus on the €3,932, the €4,761.47, the factual distinguishing of the two Cassazione cases, and settlement;
4. authorises him to open parallel settlement talks at the revised range;
5. requests his written probability estimate, drafting timetable, and confirmation of the procedural vehicle.
6. **Ask Belardi to confirm four points** before drafting:
7. that 04.05.2026 is the costituzione deadline and 14.05.2026 is the hearing;

8. whether the correct pleading is a *memoria difensiva* or a *comparsa di costituzione e risposta* under the rito semplificato (art. 281-decies c.p.c.);
 9. the **full text** of Cass. 23482/2018 and Cass. 12673/2022 and an honest assessment of whether the facts can be distinguished in Naissance's favour;
 10. whether the 04.04.2019 distribution-plan hearing minutes show the curator was present or properly notified.
 11. **Authorise Belardi to draft a PEC diffida to Avv. Fiorilli this month.** Draft it now to preserve the limitation clock on any future professional-negligence claim. Do not serve it yet.
 12. **Agree a private settlement mandate:** opening €20–25k, target **€30–40k**, walkaway **€45,000** all-in. (Total exposure if we lose outright is roughly €70–85k — capital + interest + costs + curator's legal fees — so €45k is well inside the break-even zone.)
 13. **Do NOT join Fiorilli to this proceeding and do NOT plead Naissance's €572k residual as a counterclaim.** Both are foreclosed — Fiorilli by tactical risk, the residual by art. 56 L.F. and art. 2741 c.c.
-

8. Confidence — what is solid, what needs Belardi's sign-off

Verified against the source documents directly (and through the anti-collusion critique):

- The claim arithmetic (€629,975.04 – €572,438.29 = €57,536.75).
- **The composition of €629,975.04: €616,000 + €13,975.04 only.** The €30,000 is NOT in this figure; it has been netted off by the trustee. (This is the correction that came out of the anti-collusion critique.)
- The case reference (R.G. 2505/2025; Fallimento n. 35/2018 R.G.; bankruptcy declaration judgment n. 37/2018).
- The defendant (Naissance UK Ltd, not Grahame personally).
- The Istanza's internal inconsistency (clause 3 vs clause 4).
- The FX wires (€57k on 26.04.2018, €20k on 01.05.2018, €30k on 05.06.2018 — the last corresponding to one of the cheques, per your confirmation).
- The pre-auction offers at €550k and €620k (documented in third-party emails); the €630k "accepted transaction" is on your recollection, not a third-party document.

Needs Belardi's written confirmation before the defence is filed:

- **Full text** of Cass. 23482/2018 and Cass. 12673/2022 — and his honest view on whether the facts can be distinguished. Without real factual distinguishing, the finality argument fails.
- The procedural vehicle (*memoria difensiva* vs *comparsa di costituzione e risposta*) under the rito semplificato.
- Confirmation of the 04.04.2019 hearing attendance list — was the curator there, or notified?
- His own **numeric probability estimate** on each live point (the €3,932, the €4,761.47, factual distinguishing, settlement).

Residual risks the recommended strategy does not eliminate:

- The trustee could reply to the €3,932 attack by pointing out that sums received without concorsual title are exactly *indebito oggettivo* under art. 111-bis L.F. (and Cass. 17590/2019). This is a plausible counter.
- The 2019 admission decree is *res judicata endofallimentare* — any argument that depends on reopening it fails by definition.
- Art. 56 L.F. blocks compensazione between Naissance's pre- bankruptcy residual credit and the trustee's post-bankruptcy restitution claim.
- The trustee could plead violation of *par condicio creditorum* (art. 2741 c.c.) against any residual-based counterclaim.

Confidence level: lower than the previous draft. The facts are well-traced; the strategy has been stress-tested. But the earlier draft overstated the strength of the €30,000 argument, and the true defensive ground is narrower than that draft suggested. Belardi's written view on the live quantum levers and the distinguishing of Cassazione will move confidence up or down materially.

This report is a working document prepared to support your instructions to Italian counsel. It is not itself legal advice. Belardi's written opinion, once received, supersedes it.

Final comparison — the four approaches side-by-side

#	Approach	Pros	Cons / why it fails on its own	My estimate of probability of success	Verdict
A	Your own instinct "I'm owed €1.188m, only got back ~half"	- Facts documented & accepted by trustee - Credit of €1,188,438.29 (2017 assignment) - Only €616k auction + ~€130k riparto recovered €572,438.29 admitted to stato passivo, still unpaid - Strong equitable force & common-sense appeal - Excellent settlement lever	- Italian insolvency law treats surplus-restitution as separate accounting from guarantor's make-whole position - Art. 56 L.F. set-off out of reach — trustee's claim arose post-bankruptcy - Admitted €572k ranks <i>pari passu</i> — not a euro-for-euro offset - Pleading as primary defence signals misunderstanding of Italian insolvency mechanics - Risks losing judge's sympathy for the Track 2 quantum arguments	<10% as primary Adds ~€10–15k of settlement discount if used as counterclaim alongside Approach D	Counterclaim / settlement lever only.
B	ChatGPT "Plan is final — claim is weak"	- Correct instinct on the 04.04.2019 distribution plan - Riparto was court-approved — finality is a real Italian-law principle - Simple to plead - Low legal-fee footprint	- Ignores Cass. 23482/2018 & 12673/2022 — the rulings the trustee relies on - Those rulings say finality does not automatically protect the guarantor - Misses the €30k double-count — the biggest quantum lever - Builds no settlement groundwork if the finality argument fails	Full win ~10–15% Partial win ~15–20% Full loss ~65–75%	Unsafe.
C	Avv. Belardi "Errore materiale" + Fiorilli PI fallback	- The Istanza is internally inconsistent (clause 3: €1,118,438.29 vs clause 4: €1,188,438.29) - Attached documents all show €1,188,438.29 - Preserves Fiorilli professional-indemnity route - Professionally credible; Belardi knows the Siena court	- The 2019 admission order for €572,438.29 is res judicata regardless of any typo - Addresses framing, not substantive art. 110 L.F. principle - Missing the finality argument & the €30k double-count - Leaves value on the table	Full win ~15–20% Partial win ~25–35% Full loss ~45–60%	Right direction, needs layering.
D	Recommended (revised) Narrow quantum + factual distinguishing of Cassazione + errore materiale as context + parallel settlement	- Honest, focused pleading without the €30k argument (which does not exist — trustee has already netted it) €3,932 quantum attack: trustee's own words put this outside the bankruptcy's concorso; arguable both ways €4,761.47 equitable offset for the excluded prededuzione - Factual distinguishing of Cass. 23482/2018 & 12673/2022 — if Belardi can pull it off - Errore materiale retained as contextual support (not decree-reopener) - Fiorilli PEC diffida drafted this month to preserve limitation - Parallel settlement channel at €30–40k target - Interest start date challenge (from judgment, not informal diffide)	- Upside is modest — live quantum levers are worth €3–8k of reduction, not €30k - Requires Belardi to pull the full text of both Cassazione cases and distinguish on facts, not just timing - The 2019 admission decree is <i>res judicata endofallimentare</i> (Cass. 4708/2020; SS.UU. 4309/2010) — errore materiale cannot reopen it - Art. 56 L.F. blocks Naissance's net-position credit as a formal counterclaim - Settlement is now the most likely good outcome; full win requires factual distinguishing to land - Material loss tail remains — worst case is €70–85k exposure	Full win 5–10% Partial win 35–45% Full loss 45–55% Target: settle €30–40k all-in	Recommended.

Bottom line (revised after the anti-collusion critique): the highest-probability route is still **Approach D**, but the shape has changed. The €30,000 "double-count" argument does not exist — the trustee has already netted that sum off in his arithmetic. The live defensive levers are modest: a €3,932 line item attack, a €4,761.47 equitable offset, genuine factual distinguishing of the two Cassazione cases (which Belardi has to do the real work on), and a parallel settlement channel targeting **€30–40k all-in**.

Your own instinct (Approach A) and Belardi's errore materiale (Approach C) are retained as contextual support — Approach A as a private settlement lever only, Approach C as a strand that softens the judge's view but cannot reopen the 2019 admission order.

Realistic probability: **full win 5–10%, partial win 35–45%, full loss 45–55%**. In practice, settlement at €30–40k is the most probable good outcome. Acting on the earlier, more optimistic numbers would have been a mistake.

10. Questions for you (Grahame) before the email goes to Belardi

Five short questions. Each is something only you can answer, and each would materially change the recommendation if the answer came back differently. Short replies are fine.

Q1. The €30,000 — what actually happened at the 2019 distribution?

The trustee's own figures already net the €30,000 advance off (see §5.3 above). That means the Ricorso is treating you as having got the advance back as a refund — not as a separate enrichment.

- Do your records (bank statements, Naissance accounts, Fiorilli correspondence from 2019) show receipt of **€10,043.04** at the distribution (the trustee's figure, net), or a larger amount that was later reduced?
- Are you able to confirm you actually received the €30,000 back in 2019, and when?

If the €30,000 was not actually refunded, the whole picture changes and we have a real gross-vs-net argument. If it was refunded, the trustee is arithmetically right and we should not plead the double-count.

Q2. The two cheques — what do they actually show?

There is a mismatch between the source materials and your WhatsApp clarification:

- The OCR of one cheque image shows the word **"CINQUANTAMILA"** (€50,000).
- Your WhatsApp of 18.04.2026 at 19:29 says the two cheques are **"fo 75 k. 30 and 45"** (i.e. €30,000 + €45,000).

Could you confirm the actual face values and, if possible, send clearer photos of both cheques (front and back)? This matters for whether we can put a specific cost figure in the pleading.

Q3. Is there any third-party document for the €630,000

accepted pre-auction transaction?

The €550,000 and €620,000 pre-auction expressions of interest are documented in third-party emails (Marco Gavioli via Gordana Lupi). The **€630,000 accepted transaction** so far appears only in your own 18.04.2026 email. Is there any contract, correspondence with Argo, court record, or communication with the would-be buyer that evidences the €630,000 acceptance independently? If yes, the market-value story is much stronger.

Q4. Did Fiorilli ever explain the €577,199.76 figure in 2018?

The 2018 Istanza asked for admission at €577,199.76, not at the full €1,188,438.29. Did Fiorilli discuss that choice with you at the time? Is there any email or note from 2018 explaining why?

If he explained it as a deliberate residual calculation, the "errore materiale" argument weakens. If he did not, or if his explanation was ambiguous, the argument is stronger. Any contemporaneous document is valuable.

Q5. Your walkaway — confirm the €45,000 ceiling

Given the revised outlook (full loss 45–55%; target settlement €30–40k; worst-case exposure €70–85k), please confirm privately to me that:

- **Opening settlement offer of €20–25k** is acceptable as a starting position;
- **Target landing of €30–40k** is acceptable as a successful outcome;
- **Walkaway ceiling of €45,000** remains your absolute maximum (above which we proceed to hearing and accept the full-loss risk).

If any of those need to change, please say so before the email goes to Belardi.

A one-page reply covering all five is enough. The email to Belardi can then go out the same day.